Coding Conventions

Sunny Socks website · Group 1B · how we write code together

This document keeps our code consistent, readable and fair to everyone. The goal is simple: by the end, the whole website should look and feel like it was built by one person, even though we are a team. Please read it before you start coding, and keep it open while you work.

The rules

1. **Understand and explain your code.** If you use AI or any help, that is fine, but you must understand what your code does and be able to explain it. No “magic” jumps where code works and nobody knows why. Add a short comment above anything that is not obvious.
2. **One shared style.css.** We all use the same style.css. It is the single source of the look. Do not create your own separate CSS files.
3. **Follow the folder and file structure.** Keep every file in its agreed place (pages in the pages folder, images in the images folder, and so on). Do not rename or move shared files on your own.
4. **HTML and CSS only for the structure.** For this phase we build with HTML and CSS. No JavaScript, React or other languages yet. Functionality comes later, as a team.
5. **Structure first, final product later.** Get the layout and skeleton of your pages done first. We polish and add the finishing touches together once the structure is in place.
6. **Use the global colours and sizing.** Always use the variables from the style guide (for example var(--blue), var(--font)) instead of typing raw colours or random sizes. One change then updates the whole site and we stay on brand.
7. **Pull before you code.** Before you start, always pull the latest changes from main, so you are building on everyone’s newest work and avoid conflicts.
8. **Ask when you are blocked.** If you are stuck, ask early rather than guessing for an hour. And if you see code that works but does not look right, take a look and raise it, we fix it together.
9. **Review your code before every push.** Read through your own changes before pushing. Check it works, it is tidy, and you did not leave anything broken or half-finished.
10. **Commit every time you finish something.** Make a commit whenever you finish a piece of work, with a clear message. These commits are checked by the teacher and are the proof of your individual contribution.

Naming & the shared style.css

Because we share one style.css, name your classes after your own section so they never clash, and never delete or edit someone else's code. If something of theirs looks wrong, tell them.

Do this

```
.home-hero { }
.collections-card { }
.contact-form { }
background: var(--blue);
```

Avoid

```
.box { }
.title2 { }
.red { }
background: #1e407a;
```

Commit messages

Short, in the present tense, saying what you did. Clear messages build a readable history and show what each person built.

Do this

```
"Add home hero section"
"Fix footer spacing on mobile"
"Build contact form layout"
```

Avoid

```
"stuff"
"changes"
"final final v2"
```

A few extra good habits

Keep it readable

Indent your code properly and use clear, lowercase file and class names with hyphens (for example about-page.html). Tidy code is faster for everyone to work with.

Comment the why, not the obvious

A short comment to explain a tricky part is great. You do not need to comment every line, just the parts someone else might not understand.

Test in the browser before you push

Open your page in the browser and check it actually looks right before pushing. Catching it yourself is quicker than catching it in review.

Stay on your own pages and branch

Work on the part of the website that is assigned to you, on your own branch. It keeps the work clear and avoids people editing the same files.

In one line

Pull first, build on your own branch, use the shared variables, understand your code, commit often with clear messages, review before you push, and ask when you are stuck.